



V Team Principles

Balanced Leadership Behaviors Guide



How to use this resource

As you review feedback, use this guide to help make meaning of the insights you've received. For each V Team Principle, you'll find examples of skilled behaviors, along with signs of underuse or overuse. This can support deeper reflection, help clarify strengths and development areas, and guide your next steps for growth.

V Team Principles Leadership Development Activities

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Strategic Leadership

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Be Customer Centric**Definition**

We put our customers first. Our focus begins and ends with enabling better internal and external customer experiences.

Skilled

- Enables V Teamers to deliver better customer experiences by aligning team priorities with evolving customer needs.
- Delivers on our commitment to customers by proactively solving problems and removing friction.
- Seeks, listens to, and acts on customer feedback to drive continuous improvement.
- Builds a culture of strong customer focus, helping others connect their work to end-user impact.
- Strengthens customer trust by consistently following through on commitments and delivering reliable outcomes.

Overused

- Prioritizes individual customer needs to such an extent that broader business objectives risk being overlooked.
- Over-customizes solutions, leading to inefficiencies or inconsistent experiences.
- Struggles to balance strategic goals with meeting immediate customer demands.
- Prioritizes customer satisfaction over scalability or sustainable practices.
- Creates confusion by frequently making exceptions to standard processes to accommodate requests.

Underused

- Centers more on internal tasks or processes rather than on customer needs and experiences.
- Fails to leverage customer feedback to inform improvements.
- Struggles to consistently deliver on customer-focused expectations.
- Treats customer needs as a secondary consideration instead of a guiding priority.
- Lacks proactive effort to help others connect their work to customer value.



Deliver Innovation**Definition**

What got us here, won't get us there, so we don't settle. Instead, we roll-up our sleeves, embrace and champion change to spark innovation.

Skilled

- Uses ambiguity as a spark to help others create new possibilities and solutions.
- Provokes V Teamers to stay curious and ask questions that challenge assumptions and biases.
- Champions change initiatives by modeling agility and resilience through uncertainty.
- Encourages experimentation, calculated risk-taking, and fast learning from results.
- Connects innovation to practical improvements for customers and the business.

Overused

- Introduces too many new ideas without fully assessing feasibility or impact.
- Constantly drives change without allowing teams time to stabilize or adjust.
- Challenges the status quo without providing clear alternatives or direction.
- Focuses on creativity at the expense of execution and measurable outcomes.
- Shifts focus too frequently, leading to confusion or disruption.

Underused

- Hesitates to embrace ambiguity or disrupt familiar approaches.
- Misses opportunities to spark curiosity and inspire new thinking.
- Waits passively for innovation to come from others instead of leading it.
- Fails to connect innovation efforts to customer or business needs.
- Views change as a disruption rather than as an opportunity for progress.



Activate Teamwork**Definition**

We bring others along and we win together. To do this we act unselfishly, and communicate transparently and authentically. We work together to remove obstacles to team success and we recognize and reward team performance

Skilled

- Helps others feel valued and connected by making the best use of their strengths.
- Ensures others see the connections between their success and Verizon's broader mission and future.
- Acts unselfishly, prioritizing team success over individual credit.
- Communicates transparently and authentically to build trust and drive alignment.
- Removes barriers to collaboration and celebrates shared team achievements.

Overused

- Prioritizes consensus over timely decision-making or clear accountability.
- Over-collaborates, slowing progress by seeking full agreement before acting.
- Assumes responsibility for team outcomes without appropriately delegating.
- Over-focuses on team cohesion at the expense of performance accountability.
- Creates confusion when ownership of tasks or results is unclear.

Underused

- Operates independently without leveraging team strengths or perspectives.
- Struggles to build collaborative relationships across teams and functions.
- Focuses more on individual achievements than on team or enterprise goals.
- Fails to connect others' efforts to broader business success.
- Misses opportunities to recognize team contributions and foster connection.



Embrace Inclusion

Definition

We seek diverse perspectives, listen and and create safe, open environments where every individual can belong and feel welcomed, respected, supported, and valued to fully participate.

Skilled

- Seeks out, listens to, and embraces diverse thoughts, perspectives, and viewpoints from all team members regardless of rank or tenure.
- Creates safe environments where everyone feels uniquely welcomed, valued, and supported.
- Challenges assumptions and biases thoughtfully to strengthen equity and inclusion.
- Encourages contributions from underrepresented voices and backgrounds.
- Strengthens team performance by celebrating diverse experiences and common goals.

Overused

- Invests time in dialogue without ensuring diverse input influences decisions or actions.
- Hesitates to address performance issues out of concern about perceptions of bias.
- May create divisions by emphasizing differences rather than shared strengths.
- Overemphasizes identity characteristics over common purpose and goals.

Underused

- Relies mainly on familiar groups and perspectives when making decisions.
- Misses opportunities to learn from the diversity of ideas and experiences around them.
- Struggles to create environments where all individuals feel heard and respected.
- Avoids discussions about bias, inclusion, or belonging.
- Views diversity efforts as separate from leadership excellence rather than fundamental to it.



Model Integrity

Definition

We hold ourselves accountable and always act with integrity. We don't take shortcuts or adopt a "win at all costs" mentality. We advocate for, adopt, and demonstrate our Culture OS values of Trust, Care and Excellence.

Skilled

- Creates an environment where others feel supported to consistently operate with integrity.
- Addresses underperformance and recognizes excellence to help V Teamers excel.
- Holds self and others accountable to ethical, fair, and transparent standards.
- Communicates openly and directly, even when delivering tough messages.
- Advocates for Verizon's Culture OS and consistently leads with values-driven behavior.

Overused

- Adheres to rules so strictly that it limits flexibility and the ability to adapt to complex situations.
- Shows reluctance to take necessary risks, even when such actions are ethical and aligned with strategic goals.
- Can come across as overly judgmental when addressing mistakes.
- Prioritizes strict compliance over empowerment and trust-building.
- Limits innovation or speed by over-focusing on policy adherence.

Underused

- Rationalizes actions that conflict with integrity or values.
- Avoids addressing underperformance or ethical concerns directly.
- Is inconsistent in holding self or others accountable.
- Undermines trust by communicating one thing but acting differently.
- Struggles to consistently model transparency, fairness, and ethical leadership.



Champion Growth

Definition

We support and root for one another as we learn and develop. We actively give, receive, and implement constructive feedback. We work to continuously grow and stretch beyond our current capabilities.

Skilled

- Participates actively in continuous feedback processes, giving and receiving feedback constructively.
- Role models using available resources and tools to grow and stretch beyond current capabilities.
- Encourages and supports others' development, celebrating growth milestones.
- Demonstrates a learning mindset by adapting quickly based on feedback and challenges.
- Builds a culture where development is seen as a shared responsibility and a strategic advantage.

Overuse

- Focuses so heavily on growth goals that day-to-day performance may suffer.
- Pushes continuous improvement without acknowledging progress or celebrating achievements.
- Overwhelms team members with too many development demands at once.
- Prioritizes future capabilities without balancing current business needs.
- Creates pressure by setting unrealistic expectations for non-stop growth.

Underused

- Resists feedback or fails to act on developmental input.
- Focuses primarily on immediate tasks, neglecting longer-term growth opportunities.
- Misses chances to coach, mentor, or build others' capabilities.
- Views learning and development as optional rather than essential.
- Lacks visible engagement with available tools, resources, and growth initiatives.

